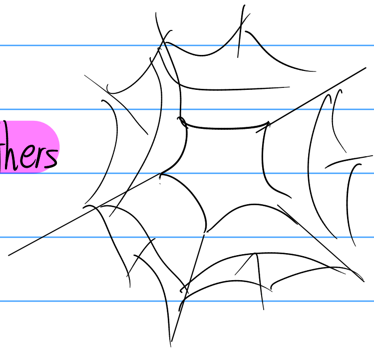
2.6 Retrieving memories

Accessing stored memories { recall : produce previously learned info
recognition : identify previously learned info

How do cues affect memory retrieval?

within our semantic networks mems held in
a web of associations

each piece of info is interconnected w/ others



when u encode a piece of info :
you associate it with other bits of info abt
surroundings - mood, postion etc.
these bits are retrieval cues

Best retrieval cues come from associations we form
when we encode a memory
smells, tastes & sights that can evoke our memory

Retrospective memory - retrieving mem from our past

Prospective memory - retrieving mem to plan for future

Strat for remembering to do something:
mentally associate act w/ cue ex. leave thing by door

Priming

Priming is the activation, often unconscious, of particular associations in mem

ex- you hear/see rabbit
- → even if you dont remember seeing/hearing it
- → likely to spell sound hair/hare as hare

priming is an implicit, invisible mem

priming can influence behaviors

people primed with money-related words change their behavior in various selfish & materialistic ways
(capitalism brings out the worst in people)

Context-dependent memory

remembering can depend on our environment

The encoding specificity principle tells us how specific cues will best trigger mem.

Ex. outside school, you may miss memory cues needed for quick facial recognition

State dependent memory

What we learn in one state is better recalled in that state.

If u learn something drunk, you will recall it better drunk

Our mem is also mood-congruent

Emotions that accompany good or bad events become retrieval cues

Depression primes negative associations, which we use to explain current mood.

Mood affects perception of others

when you are in a {x} mood, you may better recall {x} mems, prolonging {x} mood.

Serial position effect.

After hearing a list

recency effect: initially we remember last items ~still in working mem

primacy effect after delay, recall is best for first, more rehearsed, items.

How can we boost memory retrieval

Meta cognition.

Montoring & evaluating learning

figuring out what u dont know

Testing effect

repeated self-testing + rehearsal >>> re-reading

practicing recall

Inter leaving

Interleaving other subjects with one boosts long-term retention

protects against overconfidence

Personal Connection:

I have an above-average retrospective memory - but thats counteracted by my terrible prospective memory

MCQ:

1. b 2. c 3. d 4. c
5. a 6. b 7. c 8. d